FLE TRIBE

WEEK 00 · WEDNESDAY · LESSON GUIDE

What frontend is, and what it is not

This week: Understand the industry you are entering, the roles inside it, and exactly where a frontend developer fits, so the next 5 months make sense.

Frontend in one sentence

Frontend is everything a person sees and touches in the browser: the layout, the styling, what happens when they click, how fast it loads, and whether everyone, including people using screen readers or keyboards, can use it.

The restaurant analogy

In a restaurant, the **dining room** is the frontend: the menu, the tables, the waiter who takes your order. The **kitchen** is the backend: it stores ingredients (the database) and cooks the food (business logic). The waiter carrying orders between them is the **API**. A frontend developer designs and runs the dining room, and knows how to talk to the kitchen.

Frontend vs not frontend

- **Frontend**: turning designs into pages and components, layout and responsive design, interactivity, accessibility, page speed, showing data from APIs.
- **Not frontend**: designing database tables, writing server APIs, configuring servers, training AI models, creating the brand's visual identity.
- **Gray areas**: agreeing API data shapes with backend developers, deploying the frontend, server-side rendering, small design decisions when no designer is available, writing UI tests.

Research questions

Answer these in the app, in your own words, to unlock the next lesson.

1. Explain frontend vs backend using a restaurant analogy.
2. Is building a Figma design frontend work? Is writing the API it calls? Why?

Start your research here

- MDN: https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Learn_web_development/Getting_started